



Tandy Corporation/Radio Shack

News Release

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NEW TANDY 600 LAPTOP COMPUTER OFFERS FEATURES PORTABLE COMPUTER USERS WANT

The Tandy® 600 laptop computer will be introduced on Monday, October 28, at approximately 1100 Radio Shack Computer Centers, Plus Computer Centers and participating dealers and franchisees nationwide. The newest laptop from Tandy, the leader in portable computers, is an upward extension of the popular Tandy 100/200 laptop computer family.

"Laptop users asked for more contiguous memory, an 80-column display, built-in disk storage, and enhanced word processing, spreadsheet and telecommunications facilities. When we brought out the Tandy 200, the cost of the technology needed to offer those features was simply too high. Now, the costs and technology have reached the point where we're able to offer greatly enhanced features while maintaining the basic characteristics that made the Tandy 100 and 200 portable computers the laptop industry leaders," explained Bernard Appel, President of Radio Shack.

-MORE-

TANDY 600 COMPUTER -- ADD ONE

The Tandy 600 laptop computer uses the 16-bit 80C88 microprocessor, and comes with 32K RAM storage. The memory is expandable to 224K, in one contiguous memory bank. The built-in 3.5" floppy disk drive has a capacity of 360K, and the adjustable, flip-up 80 character x 16 line LCD display has a matte finish to reduce glare.

The Tandy 600 portable computer features Microsoft Works®, five very powerful, full-featured built-in applications, which are written to use key words displayed at the bottom of each screen. Application programs built into ROM on the Tandy 600 laptop computer include file management, database, word processing, spreadsheet, calendar, and telecommunications software. Built-in nicad batteries, which last approximately 11 hours between charges, are easily recharged with an AC adapter, which is included with the Tandy 600 laptop computer.

Suggested retail price for the Tandy 600 portable computer (Cat. No. 26-3901) is \$1,599.

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Microsoft Works is a trademark of Microsoft Corporation.

FACT SHEET
TANDY 600 PORTABLE COMPUTER

HARDWARE

- o The Tandy 600 portable computer contains the features Tandy 200 and Model 100 portable computer users wanted most.
- o 32K RAM available for file storage. Memory expandable to 128K or 224K with 96K memory upgrade kit, priced at \$399.95
- o Built-in 3.5" floppy disk drive, with a capacity of 360K.
- o Flip-up 80 character x 16 line LCD display with matte finish to reduce glare. Screen adjustable for most lighting situations.
- o Internal 300-baud direct connect modem, with auto answer/auto dial.
- o Low-power, 16-bit 80C88 microprocessor.
- o The Tandy 600 portable computer includes:
 - Standard RS232C connector.
 - Expansion bus for external floppy disk drive.
 - Parallel printer port.
 - Full-feature typewriter keyboard.
 - Built-in nicad batteries, and AC adapter charger.
 - Battery life is approximately 11 hours.
- o Allows the use of custom applications via optional ROM slot (by removing MultiPlan) using standard 27256 EPROMS.
- o A built-in clock includes many features not found in other portables, including auto-wakeup, which turns the unit on to answer a phone call or run an application program.
- o Automatic shutdown, or sleep function, helps conserve battery life by turning the unit off after a specific length of time.
- o Optional ROM for BASIC.

APPLICATIONS

- o The Tandy 600 portable computer includes five full-featured built-in applications, which are written to use key words displayed at the bottom of each screen.
- o SYSTEM MANAGER allows the user to run each application, exchange information between applications, and manage the files created. Information created by Multiplan can be moved into Word, etc. The System Manager handles file management for the disk drive and RAM. Date and Time are displayed on the screen.
- o WORD allows the user to produce letters, memos, and reports for office, school and personal use. Word contains all the normal word processing features including right justification, global search and replace, automatic page numbering, multiple format lines, and many others.

- o CALENDAR keeps track of daily appointments, tasks and activities. A built-in alarm can be set to remind you of appointments even when the Tandy 600 portable computer is running an application. An alarm will sound, and the screen will display the appointment or message.
- o FILE can be used as a simple or complex data base for maintaining addresses, expenses, client billing or inventory.
- o TELCOM includes auto dial, answer, wake-up and host modes. It also supports XMODEM protocol for error-free downloading of files. With the auto wake-up function, the Tandy 600 portable computer will turn itself on, call another computer and upload or download data to RAM or disk. Telcom also supports many VT-52 escape sequences for cursor positioning.
- o MULTIPLAN is a full-featured spreadsheet and the files can be transferred through Telcom to Multiplan or other applications.

AVAILABILITY, PRICE

- o On sale October 28, 1985, at approximately 1100 Radio Shack Computer Plus Centers and Computer Centers nationwide.
- o Suggested retail price for the Tandy 600 portable computer is \$1,599.